

Introduction to Web Development

WEDE5020: Proposal 1

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Group 2

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Organisation Overview

Name: THE SPOT

Brief History:

THE SPOT was founded in 2023 by K, a visual artist who recognised art as evidence of the mind's interior journey. The organisation emerged from a collection of works by artists who create as a means of traversing inner terrain

Mission:

To empower artists by providing a platform that showcases creative expression as evidence of the mind's journey, invites visitors to explore the boundless dimensions of human consciousness, and offers, for those who seek it, education and advocacy at the intersection of art and mental health.

Vision:

A world where every mind finds witness, where art is recognised as both archive and experience, and where those who wish to understand more deeply find resources waiting.

Target Audience:

- Artists (emerging and established) seeking a non-commercial platform
- Art enthusiasts
- Mental health advocates and organisations
- Individuals exploring mental health
- Students, educators, and researchers

The Realms:

Each realm within THE SPOT represents a distinct artistic medium and serves as a gateway into the different expression of the mind's interior landscape. The following table outlines the six realms

Realm	Art Style
Ink Corridors	Pen and Ink
Graphite Pathways	Pencil Sketch
Charcoal Depths	Charcoal
Pigment Fields	Oil Painting
Watercolor Drifts	Watercolor
Digital Dreamscape	Digital Art

Website Goals and Objectives

Goal	Objectives	Key Performance Indicators
1. Establish Digital Archive	Create a platform where artists can submit work that documents their inner experience	- Number of artist submissions received - Number of approved pieces added to archive - Artist retention rate (Repeat submissions)

2. Drive user engagement through immersive exploration	Design and develop a dimensional realm structure that encourages visitors to explore multiple art styles (see <i>Organisation overview</i>)	- Average session duration - Cross-realm viewing - Homepage bounce-rate - Pages per session
3. Build an engaged community of artists and viewers/witnesses	Foster a growing community around the organisation's mission	- Social media growth and engagement rates - User-generated content - Community feedback and interaction - Newsletter sign-ups open rates
4. Establish organisational credibility and reach	Position the spot as a recognised voice in the South African arts and mental health landscape	- Collaborative projects initiated - Media mentions and features - Grant or funding applications submitted - Average time on blog pages and use of external backlinks
5. Provide educational resources (through useful links) at the intersection of art and thought	Develop a section containing curated resources	- User feedback on resource usefulness (collected via optional form or satisfaction survey)

6. Ensure technical excellence and accessibility	Develop a website that meets internationally recognised benchmarks for accessible webdesign. It should also achieve a relatively high mobile-friendly score.	- Page-load speed - User reported technical issues - Mobile responsiveness results - Uptime monitoring data
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Current Website Analysis

Three established online art platforms were examined to inform the design and feature set of THE SPOT; **Saatchi Art**, **Artsy**, and **Behance**.

The element of a solely content based organization like Saatchi Art demonstrates the value of curation and strategic placement of content, Artsy excels at combining artwork with detailed metadata, aiding the audience to understand each piece in an artistic context. Behance emphasises visual presentation and project based storytelling.

Together, they validate THE SPOT' focus on a clean, progressive layout that provides detailed artwork information.

Proposed Website Features and Functionality

Core Features

Feature	Description
Dimensional realm navigation	A visual navigation system allowing users to explore art by realm. Each realm has its own curated gallery.
Artwork display with progressive discovery	Each realm page opens with a single "featured artwork". Below, additional works are presented in pairs as "exploration cards" with a "Load more" option. Clicking any piece opens a lightbox modal with full image and metadata (title, artist, medium, dimensions, year, artist statement)

Artist submission portal	A form-based system allowing artists to submit artwork and metadata. Submissions enter a moderation queue for administrator review public display
About sections	A dedicated page presenting THE SPOT's lore, founder's philosophy, mission, vision, and brief history
Contact page	A contact form and email address for inquiries, partnership proposals, and general communication
Social media intergration	Links to THE SPOT's Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube channels, placed in the footer for consistent visibility across all pages
Responsive design	Full functionality across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices, ensuring accessibility for all users

Additional Features

Art and The Mind	A section exploring the convergence of artistic expression and inner experience, containing the two subsections: Blog; Original articles, artist reflections and philosophical explorations written by the founder, with occasional contributions from artists and mental health professionals personally interviewed by K. - Content themes involve artist interviews, reflections on creative process, explorations of specific realms, pieces on art, mind and mental health Useful links directory: Curated list of South African mental health
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	organisations for those seeking additional support or information. - Simple, clean listing of organisations (SADAG, NICRO, SAFMH, ect) each with a brief description and a direct link to their website - Initially a basic list. As directory grows, it may evolve into categorised listings (youth services, crisis support, art therapy) based on depth and quality of information available - Links only. No hosting of thirdparty materials. A disclaimer clarifying that the organisation does not endorse or control external content.
Newsletter intergration	An email sign-up form for users interested in updates on new art and featured artists
Search and filter	Functionality allowing users to filter art by realm, artist, or keyword (e.g title, description, tags)

Design and user experience

THE SPOT's visual identity is rooted in its founding philosophy (*See Organisation Overview*), therefore the design must feel like a space to be explored, calm, contemplative, and gently mysterious. Every color to typography is chosen to support this atmosphere while ensuring accessibility and clarity.

Color Palette

Color	Hex	Role
Void	#1A1A2E	Primary background. Provides a dark, nondistracting canvas that lets artwork stand forward. Its low luminosity reduces eye strain during extended viewing

Threshold	#4A4A6A	Secondary backgrounds, cards, and footers. A transitional tone that visually separates content layers while maintaining the dark, immersive environment
Flicker	#E0E0FF	Primary text, body, copy, subtle icons. Offers high contrast against dark backgrounds
Portal	#7C3AED	Accents, link, buttons, and interactive states
Witness	#F5F5F5	Light backgrounds for modals, lightboxes, and artist statement panels. Ensures high readability.

Typography

- Headings: Serif, Cormorant Garamond
- Body text: Sans-Serif, Lato
- Lore Excerpts: Italic Cormorant Garamond

Layout Approach

- Mobile first, responsive
- Progressive discovery (featured artwork, paired cards)
- Generous whitespace
- Consistent navigation with breadcrumbs

Low – fidelity wireframes

A complete set of wireframes for the homepage, realms page, lightbox modal, Art and Mind page, about page, contact page, and artist submission portal has been created. These wireframes follow the structure and design decisions described in some sections of this document. They are available separately in the attached document.

Technical requirements

Requirement	Specification
Hosting	Cloud-shared hosting with storage and daily backups

Domain	(org.za)
Technologies	HTML,CSS, JavaScript
Accessibility	WCAG 2.1 Level AA compliance
Security	CAPTCHA on submission and contact forms.

Timeline and Milestones

Milestone	Target date
Project planning	24 March 2026
Research and content gathering	26 March 2026
Proposal development	28 March 2026
HTML structure and file organisation	1-10 April 2026
Final review and polish	13-19 April 2026
Submission (Part 1)	20 April 2026

Budget

Item	Estimated Cost
Domain registration	R150 (Annually renewed)
Web hosting	R1800 - R150 per month on average depending on the provider - Includes shared hosting and daily backups
Email hosting	R400 to R900 annually depending on the provider.
Contingency fund	R1000
Total (year)	R3350 – R3850

This breakdown is for an in-house development, as outsourcing would incur higher costs.

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